

Habakkuk: Trusting When Life Is Unfair

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 72 of 80

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*Enbaqom ab Hanti kab zits'elmete ewnat tariKh Yihuda nebere. FitiHi Amlak
 kenits'ebariq zigba'o zinebere hager Amlak zits'ela'o kulu mestiyal kone. Amets'
 nigodentat mel'o — Hayalat bizey sa'iben nidiKhumat yichifilikqu neberu. BiliHuqat
 daynatat niHigi nihabtamat kem ziTeqim yiTiwyu diKhatat gina dimtsi wey mets'leli
 ayneberomon.*

[PICTURE: Habakkuk on his knees in a dimly lit room, hands raised toward heaven, face contorted with raw emotion — a mixture of desperation, frustration, and longing. His mouth is open in a passionate cry. Through the window behind him, scenes of violence and injustice are visible in the streets. Tears stream down his face as he prays boldly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"How long, Lord, must I call for help, but you do not listen?" Habakkuk's first complaint explodes from his lips like a dam breaking. This is not polite prayer — this is raw, desperate, anguished honesty with God. "How long?" — he has been praying about this for a long time. This is not a new concern; it is a burden he has carried until he cannot carry it anymore. "Must I call for help" — he has been actively crying out, not passively accepting. "But you do not listen" — this is the hardest part. It feels like God is deaf, absent, unconcerned. Notice that Habakkuk does not stop praying. He does not walk away from God. He brings his frustration TO God, not away from Him. This is the model for honest faith: you can be completely raw, completely frustrated, completely confused — and still direct it all toward God rather than away from Him. The opposite of faith is not doubt; it is indifference. Habakkuk doubts God's timing but never doubts God's existence. He questions God's methods but never abandons the conversation.

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*Goytaye kisab me'as Hagez kits'uw'e nisKha gina zeytisme'e? Nay Enbaqom qedamay
 Tir'an kem zitesebere gidib kab kenafu yifinjer. Izi qirts' zelewo ts'elot aykonen —
 giluts', tesfa ziqerets'e, saqe zelewo qin'ina mis Amlak iyu. "Kisab me'as?" —
 biza'iba'zi newiH gize ts'eliyu alo. Hadish sig'at aykonen — kisab kits'ewir zeyKh'il
 zits'eneHe ts'or iyu.*

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*Nimintay zeyfitHi ker'i'i tigebreni? Nimintay nigif'i tits'awer? Tir'an Enbaqom yi'amuq.
Kifu'e niAmlak ts'ebts'ab tiray aykonen zigebir — keygebere kiri'iyo Amlak kem
zigededo yiKthesis alo. "Nimintay ker'i'i tigebreni" — kem Amlak sqay kiri'i aqemiTwo
ginake mi'itaw yi'abi zikone. "Nimintay nigif'i tits'awer?" — izi qal "tits'awer" zeqats'il
iyu.*

Slezi Higi senfet, fitHi fets'imu ay'iwetin. Resi'an nits'adqan yiKhebuwom slezi fitHi yiTewawye. Enbaqom nisebat nimiHlaw zitemedebe kulu sir'at zitebelashewe Hibrete seb yigelts'. Higi — Hibrete seb nimisir'at wihbet Amlak — "senfet" kiserH ayKh'ilin mikniyatu ketegbiru zigba'om niwilqawi Tiqmi yiTiwyu.

Scene 5 of 25

[PICTURE: God responding from heaven — shown as brilliant light breaking through dark clouds. Below, Habakkuk looks up in shock, his mouth open. But instead of seeing angels of deliverance, the light reveals a terrifying army of Babylonian warriors on the horizon — fierce, brutal, unstoppable. God's answer is not what Habakkuk expected. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God answers — but His answer is more shocking than His silence. "Look at the nations and watch — and be utterly amazed. For I am going to do something in your days that you would not believe, even if you were told." God is not silent. He IS working. But His plan is so unexpected, so counterintuitive, so beyond human logic that even if someone explained it, you would not believe it. God's answer to Judah's internal corruption is external judgment. He will use the Babylonians — a pagan, brutal, godless empire — as His instrument of discipline against His own people. This is God's most disturbing answer to the problem of evil: sometimes He addresses injustice through even greater upheaval. The surgery required to remove the cancer is painful. The breaking required before rebuilding is violent. Habakkuk asked God to act, and God says "I AM acting — but not in the way you imagined." Be careful what you pray for. When you ask God to deal with injustice, His methods may terrify you. His timeline may confuse you. His instruments may offend you. But He IS working.

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Amlak yimilish — ginake melsu kab siqitau nila'ili zisdemim iyu. "Nab hageratat ri'ayu temelketu — bimilu'e tegeremu. Mikniyatu ab zemenKum Hade neger kigebir iye wala tengiruKum'win aymi'amenKumwon." Amlak siq aybeLen. YiserH alo. Ginake iqidu kindau zeyitets'ebeKhayo, kindau nimismirti zits'arer, kindau li'ili nay seb lojik sle zikone wala Hade seb gelitsulKa ayimi'amenKayon.

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*Nibibilonawiyān yitensi'e aleKhu, neti zeymihir qiliTaf hizbi, nay geza'e ri'isom
 zeykone menberi nimiHaz nimilu'e midri zigwa'az. Amlak nay firdu mesarHi bizefriH
 zirizir yigelts'. Babilonawiyān "zeymihiru" — mirHet zeybilom. "QiliTufat" — nimidlaw
 gize zeyhib bi'amets'awi qiliTafe zigebru.*

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Resi'an kab'om ziqenu mis yiwuHTu nimintay siq tibil? Nay Enbaqom kal'ay Tir'an kab qedamay nila'ili difur iyu. Nay Amlak melsi semi'u ni'u ayrid'on. "Ts'inHa — biKefil resi'an zikonu bimilu'e resi'an teTeqimKa kitifrid iKha? Izi Kemey fitHi iyu?" Yihuda bilshiwna nebera iwe — ginake mis Babilon kitwdader qidusan neberu.

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*A'intiKha kifu'e nimri'ay azyen nitsuhat iyen — gif'i kitits'awer aytiKh'ilin. Enbaqom
 Hiji bahriy Amlak ba'ilu ants'ar Amlak yiTqem — bizey akbirot zeykone bisine-
 melekotawi lik'inet. Bimseretu yibil "Amlak men miwKhanKa azkirKa. Nits'uH iKha.
 Kifu'e kitiri'i aytiKh'ilin. Gif'i kitits'awer aytiKh'ilin."*

Scene 9 of 25

[PICTURE: Habakkuk climbing to the top of a city watchtower at dawn. He stands at the highest point, his posture upright and alert, eyes fixed on the horizon, waiting. Below the city sleeps, but the prophet is awake, positioned to hear God's response. His stance communicates patient expectation — not passive resignation, but active, watchful waiting. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"I will stand at my watch and station myself on the ramparts; I will look to see what he will say to me, and what answer I am to give to this complaint." After pouring out his complaint, Habakkuk does something remarkable: he positions himself to listen. He doesn't just vent and walk away. He doesn't complain and then give up on God answering. He intentionally goes to a watchtower — the highest point — and waits. This is the posture of mature faith: honest complaint FOLLOWED BY patient expectation. Many people are good at the complaint part but terrible at the waiting part. They express their frustration but then don't stay long enough to hear God's response. Habakkuk teaches us the complete cycle: bring your honest questions to God, then WAIT for His answer. Position yourself to hear — through Scripture, through prayer, through wise counsel, through the quiet voice of the Spirit. God always answers honest questions, but His answers come on His timeline, not ours. The watchtower represents intentional positioning — choosing to be where you can hear God rather than where noise drowns Him out.

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*Ab Halewey dew kibil ab li'ili gimbi dima kiqewm — intay kem zibleni nazi Tir'an dima
 intay melsi kem zihibeni kiri'i. Tir'anu mis afisese Enbaqom zigerim neger yigebir —
 niKhism'e yiqewm. Afisisu ayKeydun. Amlak yimilsh tesfa aquritsu ayTer'in. BiflaT nab
 nay Halewa gimbi — zile'ale bota — yiKeyd yits'be.*

Scene 10 of 25

[PICTURE: God's voice coming as golden words that materialize in the air before Habakkuk on the watchtower. The words form into a large scroll that Habakkuk reaches out to touch. The words glow with certainty and authority: "Write down the revelation." A quill and parchment appear in Habakkuk's hands as heaven commissions him to record what he hears. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Then the Lord replied: Write down the revelation and make it plain on tablets so that a herald may run with it." God's second answer begins not with explanation but with instruction: WRITE IT DOWN. Make it permanent. Make it clear. Make it accessible so that even someone running past can read it. Why? Because this message is not just for Habakkuk — it is for every generation that will face the same question. God is saying: "What I am about to tell you is so important that it must be preserved, recorded, and proclaimed." When God tells you to write something down, it means the answer has eternal significance. It will be needed again and again. The revelation God gives is not complex philosophy — it is simple, clear truth that can be understood even in motion, even in crisis, even when you're running through the chaos of life. God's deepest truths are not hidden in complexity. They are plain, accessible, memorable. The answer to the deepest question of suffering is not an academic treatise — it is a declaration that can fit on a single tablet and be read at a glance.

[illegible]

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DiHri'u Goyta meleshe: Ra'iy ts'iHafo ab ts'ilat gilts'o anbabi bimribats' kinebbo mi'inti. Nay Amlak kal'ay melsi bigelets'a zeykone bimemerHi yijmir — ts'iHafo. Qewami gibero. Giluts' gibero. Wala bimribats' ziHalif seb kenibbo kiKh'il tereKhabi gibero. Nimintay? Mikniyatu izi meliKhti niEnbaqom tiray aykonen — niHade Hito zigaTemu kulom weledo iyu.

Scene 11 of 25

[PICTURE: A large hourglass in the center of the image, with golden sand slowly falling. Habakkuk watches the hourglass with a mixture of impatience and growing trust. Around the hourglass, seasons change — spring turns to summer turns to autumn turns to winter — time passes. But beneath the hourglass, the words "It will certainly come" glow with unshakeable certainty. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"For the revelation awaits an appointed time; it speaks of the end and will not prove false. Though it linger, wait for it; it will certainly come and will not delay." God gives Habakkuk two crucial truths about His timing. First: there is an "appointed time" — God's justice is not random or accidental; it is precisely scheduled. He has a specific moment in mind when everything will be set right. Second: "Though it linger, wait for it." God acknowledges that from our perspective, His timing FEELS slow. He does not deny that waiting is hard. He does not scold Habakkuk for being impatient. He simply says: wait. It WILL come. This is the hardest part of faith — trusting God's timing when your clock says He's late. Every teenager knows this feeling: waiting for an answer to prayer that seems overdue, waiting for a situation to change that seems permanent, waiting for justice that seems impossible. God says: "My timing is perfect even when it feels delayed. What I promised WILL happen. It is not late — it is appointed. And appointed times cannot be moved by human impatience or accelerated by human effort."

"፳፻፲፱ ጥቅም ጥቅም፡፡ ጥቅም ጥቅም — ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም፡፡ ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም — ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም፡፡" ጥቅም ጥቅም፡፡ ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም "ጥቅም ጥቅም" ጥቅም — ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም — ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም "ጥቅም ጥቅም ጥቅም" ጥቅም

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*Mikniyatu ra'iy nizitemedebe gize yits'be — biza'iba meweda'eta yizareb Hasot dima
aykonen. Wala zidengi ts'beyo — birigts' kimits'e iyu ayHalifin dima. Amlak
niEnbaqom biza'iba gize'u kilte agedesti Haqitat yihib. Qedamay, "zitemedebe gize"
alo — fitHi Amlak zikone zibele wey biHawri aykonen — bilik'e zitemedebe iyu.*

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*Ts'adiq bi'imnetu kinebir iyu. Izi nay milu'e mets'Haf ma'ikelay awaj iyu — ni'alem
ziqeyeru Hamushte qalat. Izi Hade Tiqsi Martin Luter mis anbebo nay protestant
teHadso agafi'u. Pawlos ab Hadish Kidan seleste gize yiTeqso. Nay Qidus ts'Huf sine-
melekot libi triggita iyu. Ginake ab awdu intay malet iyu?*

Scene 13 of 25

[PICTURE: Five dark thunderclouds descending upon a grand but corrupt Babylonian palace. Each cloud has lightning striking down, representing the five "woes" God pronounces. The palace crumbles under the weight of divine judgment. Babylonian soldiers who once seemed invincible now cower in fear. Justice is delayed but never cancelled. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God pronounces five "woes" against Babylon — He WILL judge the unjust. After telling Habakkuk to wait, God assures him that waiting does not mean forgetting. Babylon will face consequences for every act of cruelty. "Woe to him who piles up stolen goods!" — every empire built on theft will collapse under the weight of what it stole. "Woe to him who builds his house by unjust gain!" — wealth accumulated through exploitation carries a curse, not a blessing. God is not blind to injustice. He is not deaf to the cries of the oppressed. He is building a case, accumulating evidence, and when His appointed time arrives, judgment will be swift, complete, and irreversible. This is God's message to every person who has been wronged: "I see. I remember. I will act." And to every person who wrongs others: "You may escape human courts, but you will never escape mine." Justice delayed is not justice denied — it is justice being perfected, made complete, timed for maximum impact and minimum collateral damage.

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 ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ
 ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ ለእኔም ለሌሎች ስለሆነ

Amlak Hamushte "weyle" ab li'ili Babilon yi'wiji — nizeyifitHawiyān kifrid iyu.

NiEnbaqom ts'be mis belo Amlak mits'bay miris'a'e kem zeykone yereggats'elu.

Babilon nikulu chikane'a sa'bien kitigaTema iya. "Nay kal'e zizerefe weyle'u!" —

bisiriqi ziteHants'e kulu giz'at bikibdet zisereqo kifris iyu.

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፡፡፡'፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡
፡፡ — ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡
፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ — ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡
፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ — ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡፡
፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡፡

*ZeyfitHawi rebHa ziKhses weyle'u... bideṃ minzaH ketema ziHants'e weyle'u...
gorebabbtu siKer zihib kisilkiru kab bilHiti zistiyom iraqutom nimri'ay weyle'u. Amlak
ab li'ili fluyat HaTiyatat weyle'u yiqTs'il: niwilqawi rebHa niKhal'ot zimimzimiz sisie,
bideṃ minzaH silTan ziHanTs' amets', niwilqawi desta sebawi kibret zewwarid
mimzimeza.*

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 ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ — ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ
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*Mikniyatu midri bifilit kibri Goyta kitimle'e iya mayat nibaHri kem ziKhednu. Firdi ab
 mi'iwwaj ma'ikel Amlak nezi zisdemim nay fits'um tesfa tesfa yiseKu'e. Iwe Hiji zeyfitHi
 alo. Iwe kifu'e Hayal yimesil. Iwe mits'bay newiH iyu. Ginake — filiTet kibri Amlak kem
 may wuqiyanos zeytiqwarets' tiKhewnelu me'alti yimits'e alo.*

Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: A magnificent heavenly temple with God seated on His throne in brilliant, overwhelming glory. Below, the entire earth — nations, peoples, armies, empires — all standing in absolute silence. Not forced silence but awed silence. Every mouth is closed. Every argument has ceased. Every complaint is swallowed up in the overwhelming reality of God's holy presence. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"But the Lord is in his holy temple; let all the earth be silent before him." After all the complaints, all the questions, all the woes — God brings everything to a stunning conclusion with this declaration. He is still on His throne. He is still in control. He is still holy. And the appropriate response? Silence. Not the frustrated silence of unanswered questions, but the awed silence of someone who has finally glimpsed the bigger picture. When you truly encounter God's sovereignty — when you realize that He really IS working all things together for good, that His justice WILL prevail, that His timing IS perfect — words become unnecessary. Arguments dissolve. Complaints transform into worship. This is where Habakkuk's journey is heading: from shouting complaints at God to standing in silent awe before Him. Not because his questions were wrong, but because he has received enough of an answer to trust God with the rest. Sometimes the deepest faith is expressed not in words but in silence — the silence of trust, the silence of surrender, the silence of a soul that has stopped fighting and started resting.

"ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ — ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ" ጌላጌ
ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ — ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ ጌላጌ
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ፍጥረት — ስሙ ስሙ ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት
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ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት ስሙ ፍጥረት

*Ginake Goyta ab Qidus bete meqdesu alo — kula midri ab qidmi'u siq tibet. DiHri
kulu Tir'anat, kulu Hitotat, kulu weyle — Amlak kulu neger nab zisdemim
medemdemta bizi awaj yamits'e. Gena ab zufanu alo. Gena yiqoTs'ats'er alo. Gena
Qidus iyu. Gibu'e milash dima? Siqita.*

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Nay Enbaqom ts'elot ab mi'raf 3 mezmur iyu — nay Amlak ziHalefe amunnet ziznito qine. Nay Amlak melsi teqebilu Enbaqom kab Tir'an nab amlKho yiqeyer. Ginake kemey kem zi'amlKh astebhil — bimzkar. Nay Amlak gezefti gibirtat bitariKh yizkir — baHritat miflaT, aKhran minqinaq, serawit mis'ar, nidiKhumat midhHan.

ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ ሰጠኝ
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*Sema'iKu libey dima hareme, kenafrey bidimts'u niqiniq abela — mibisbas ab ats'mey
 atewe igrey dima neqaneqe. Nay Enbaqom mis Amlak miriKhab bi'akal yits'eliwo.
 Libu yiharim, kenafru yiniqniqqu, ats'mu diKhum yism'o, a'igaru kits'ewru ayKh'ilun.*

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Om beles wala aytitTi'e ab weyni dima fire wala ayhalu, nay awli'e ats'id wala yifeshil gawtni dima migbi wala ayefriya... Enbaqom Hiji ab HirshHawi qalat temelkettu qeliTi'fom zird'u ziKhif'e kunetat yise'al. Om beles zeytitTi'e malet aqedimu nay tesfa miliklit feshilu malet iyu.

[illegible]

...ab dembe wala abagi'e ayhalu ab maHqwer dima wala kebti ayhalu... Enbaqom
ziKhif'e kunetat mihnataTs' yiqTs'il. Abagi'e zeymihlaw malet niKhidan suf yelen,
nimeswa'eti genshel yelen, nimishaT megwase yelen. Kebti zeymihlaw malet nimiHras
gulbet yelen, nimimgab ts'eba yelen, nidiHnnet habti yelen.

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"ገብረ" ገብ ገብ ገብረ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ ገብ
— ገብ ገብ ገብረገብ

*Ginake ab Goyta kiHgos iye. Izi Hade qal — "ginake" — minalbat ab milu'e Qidus
ts'Huf aziyu Hayal qal iyu. Milu'e mets'Haf Enbaqom zizoruhu mezgi iyu. Ab qidmi'u
zelo kulu sikfta, girat, tesfa miqurats', zeytemeleshe Hitotat iyu. DiHri'u zelo kulu
imnet, tesfa, Hagos, amlKho iyu.*

— ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ — ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ
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*Ab Amlak medHaniye kiHgos iye. Enbaqom kab miHgwas mimirats' nila'ili yiKeyd —
 nay Hagosu minCHi yileli. "Negartat kimiHayeshu sle zikonu kiHgos iye" aykonen
 (zeyka'alu yiKh'ilu). "Iqidi Amlak sle zird'a kiHgos iye" aykonen (ayrid'on). "Kal'ot sle
 ziri'yuni kiHgos iye" aykonen (biHtawi amlKho iyu). Ginake "ab Amlak kiHgos" —
 Amlak ba'ilu minCHi, mikniyat, nay Hagosu elama iyu.*

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: Habakkuk being filled with strength — golden energy flowing from heaven into his body, strengthening his arms, his legs, his spine. He stands tall where moments ago he trembled. The source of the strength is clearly external — from God above — not from within himself. He is being empowered, not by his own resolve but by divine infusion. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"The Sovereign Lord is my strength." After declaring his joy, Habakkuk identifies his power source. Not "my willpower is my strength" — willpower runs out. Not "my positive attitude is my strength" — attitudes fluctuate. Not "my support system is my strength" — people can disappear. But "the Sovereign LORD" — the One who rules over all circumstances, who controls what confuses me, who reigns even when everything seems chaotic — HE is my strength. "Sovereign" means supreme in authority. When Habakkuk calls God "Sovereign," he acknowledges that God is in charge even when life feels out of control. The same God who is sovereign over the Babylonians, sovereign over the timing, sovereign over the injustice — THAT God is his personal source of strength. This means the power behind Habakkuk's "yet" is not human determination or emotional grit. It is divine enablement. God does not just COMMAND us to rejoice in suffering — He EMPOWERS us to do it. He gives the very strength He requires. You are not expected to white-knuckle your way through suffering. You are expected to draw on a strength that is not your own.

"ገብረ ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም" ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም
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 ሰላም ሰላም" ሰላም ሰላም — ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም ሰላም "ገብ ሰላም" — ሰላም ሰላም

፳፱ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን —
፳፱ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ "፳፱" ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡን ሕዝቡን
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ሕዝቡ "፳፱" ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ —
፳፱ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ ሕዝቡ — ሕዝቡ
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*Li'ul Amlak Goyta Hayley iyu. Hagosu mis awaje Enbaqom nay Hayli minchu yileliy.
"Dilyetey Hayley iyu" aykonen — dilyet yiwda'e. "Awentawi ameleKhaKhtay Hayley iyu"
aykonen — ameleKhaKhta yiqeyer. "Nay degef sir'atey Hayley iyu" aykonen — sebat
kiTef'u yiKh'ilu. Ginake "Li'ul Goyta" — ab li'ili kulu kunetat zigez'e, zidenagireni
ziqoTs'ats'er, kulu milwilwat wala yimesil kelo zigez'e — nisu Hayley iyu.*

Scene 24 of 25

[PICTURE: Habakkuk transformed into a figure leaping with supernatural agility — his feet depicted like deer hooves, bounding up a steep, rocky mountain path that would be impossible for ordinary feet. Below, the difficult terrain of life's challenges. But with these deer feet, he navigates heights that should be impossible. He is not just surviving — he is CLIMBING, going higher through the hardship. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"He makes my feet like the feet of a deer, he enables me to tread on the heights." The final image is stunning. A deer (specifically a mountain doe) can navigate terrain that would kill any other animal. Steep cliffs, narrow ledges, sheer rock faces — the deer moves with impossible grace and confidence. God doesn't promise to remove the difficult terrain. The mountain is still steep. The path is still narrow. The challenges are still real. But He changes your FEET — He gives you the ability to navigate what should be impossible. "The heights" in Scripture represent both difficulty and triumph. The same mountain that threatens to destroy you becomes the platform from which you see furthest. Habakkuk started this book in a valley of confusion, questioning God from a place of despair. He ends it on the heights — not because circumstances changed, but because GOD changed him. He can now climb what once would have crushed him. This is God's promise: I won't always remove the mountain, but I will always give you the feet to climb it.

"፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡
፡፡፡፡፡፡" ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ (፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡) ፡፡፡፡፡
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፳፻፱ ሕዝቦች

*A'igarey kem a'igar diKhala yigebir ab li'ili la'ilewey botatat dima kimelales yeKh'ileni.
Nay meweda'eta s'ili zisdemim iyu. DiKhala (bi፻፲፱T nay keren diKhala) nizikone kal'e
insisa ziqetil bota kitmelales tiKh'il. Quliqu፻ ts'edfi, ts'ebib Terzi, qirqir kewHi gets' —
diKhala bizeyKe'al ts'egan miti'immanin tiniqesages.*

ገብረ ገብረ ገብረገብ ገብረገብ ገብረ ገብ ገብረገብ ገብረገብ ገብረ ገብ ገብረ
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ገብረገብ ገብረገብ ገብረ ገብረገብ ገብረ ገብ ገብረገብ ገብ ገብረገብ
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ገብረ ገብረገብ ገብረ — ገብረ ገብረገብ ገብረ — ገብ ገብ ገብረገብ ገብ

*Tegbar: kab Tir'an nab amlKho — nay Amlak gize zi'amin qinu'e imnet. Gu'izo
Enbaqom mis zeyfitHi ziqales nikulu amani mangedi yiHbir. Dereja Hade: qinu'e
Tir'an. Giluts'at Hitotatka nab Amlak amts'e. Ts'elotatka aytetsi'riyom. Ts'ibuq zeykone
kelo ts'ibuq aytimesil. Amlak tesfa miqurats'Ka, quT'eKha, giratiKa kits'ewir yiKh'il.*

The Moral of the Story

English: Honest questioning does not destroy faith — it deepens it. Habakkuk shows us that we can bring our rawest complaints to God without fear of rejection. God is not threatened by our questions; He welcomes them. But honest questioning must be paired with patient waiting and willing trust. God's timing is not our timing. His methods often confuse us. His instruments sometimes offend us. But He is always working, always just, always faithful. The righteous live not by understanding everything but by trusting the One who does. And when we choose to say "yet I will rejoice" in the midst of loss, confusion, and apparent injustice, God Himself becomes our strength and transforms us from complainers into worshippers who can climb heights we never imagined possible.

Tigrinya: ስላሳ ስላሳ ስላሳሳ ስላሳሳሳ — ስላሳሳ ስላሳሳ ስላሳ ስላሳሳ
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 ስላሳ ስላ ስላሳ ስላሳ ስላ ስላሳ ስላሳ ስላ ስላሳ ስላ ስላሳ ስላሳ ስላሳ
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Key Verse - Habakkuk 3:17-18: "Though the fig tree does not bud and there are no grapes on the vines... yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will be joyful in God my Savior."

ጳጳስ ጳጳስ - ጳጳስጳጳ **3:17-18:** "ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ
ጳጳጳጳ... ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ"

4. Habakkuk's journey goes from complaint (chapters 1-2) to worship (chapter 3). What caused this transformation? He never received a full explanation for WHY God allows injustice — so what changed? How does remembering God's past faithfulness help us trust Him in present confusion? What "past faithfulness" can you remember today?

5. The word "yet" in Habakkuk 3:18 represents choosing joy when everything says you should despair. Is it possible to genuinely rejoice when life is falling apart, or is that just denial? What is the difference between fake happiness and choosing joy anchored in God? How can you practice saying "yet" in your own difficult circumstances this week?

[illegible]

A Prayer of Honest Faith

God, I come to You honestly today. I don't understand everything happening in my life and in the world around me. I see injustice and it makes me angry. I see suffering and it confuses me. I have questions I cannot answer and frustrations I cannot resolve on my own. Like Habakkuk, I bring these complaints directly to You — not to disrespect You, but because I trust You enough to be real with You.

Why does life feel so unfair sometimes? Why do the wrong people seem to prosper while good people suffer? Why does Your timing feel so slow when my heart is breaking now? I don't understand Your methods, Lord. I don't always see Your hand at work. The silence is hard. The waiting is painful. The confusion is real.

But here, in the middle of my questions, I choose to remember who You are. You are the God who parted seas, who raised the dead, who kept every promise You ever made. You are the God who has been faithful to me before — in moments I almost forgot, in ways I didn't even notice at the time. Your track record is perfect even when my present feels broken.

So I make my declaration today: THOUGH I don't understand... THOUGH life feels unfair... THOUGH I cannot see the end from here... YET I will rejoice in You. Yet I will trust Your character when I cannot trace Your hand. Yet I will anchor my joy in who You ARE rather than what I can SEE.

Sovereign Lord, be my strength. I cannot do this on my own resolve. Give me deer feet for the mountains ahead. Transform my complaints into worship. Not by removing my questions, but by giving me enough of You to trust You with the rest. I choose faith today — not because I

[illegible][illegible][illegible]

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Contact: dannyshalom.etsy.com

Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com

WhatsApp: +971525950021

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